

How do you manage capacity when you can't even see the work?

When I arrived, Enablement didn't just lack dashboards. It lacked the operating infrastructure needed to produce the data.

- Data and Measurement
- Transformation Experience
- AI and Technology Experience

I arrived in March and couldn't answer basic questions.



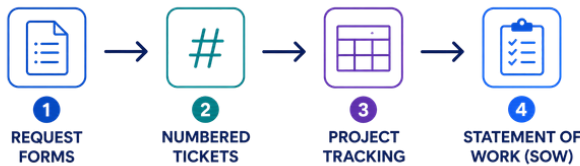
There was no project-management system, standardized intake, completion hierarchy, or consistent metrics.

I didn't immediately replace anything.

I let an employee stretch into a problem and build something she thought would work. We used it for about five months. When she left and I suddenly found myself rebuilding the team while also *being* the team, I rebuilt the system around two principles:

- Make it easy for people to get to us.**
- Make it easy for us to manage what happens next.**

That became request forms, numbered tickets, project tracking, eventually a formal Statement of Work (SOW).



Then one disagreement exposed a design flaw.

Our SOW showed one timeline, but work was happening on multiple. The tool was too simple for a complex process, and had to be updated.



But I still needed to answer three questions.

- OPERATIONS**
How are we doing?
✓ Budget
✓ Systems
✓ Capacity
- PRODUCTIVITY**
What are we doing?
✓ Projects
✓ Assets
✓ Systems
- PERFORMANCE**
Is it working?
✓ Engagement
✓ Completion
✓ Sales lift

I defined the metrics, designed the dashboards, structured the underlying project data, and vibe-coded the solution myself.

It became a tool I used to govern the now-larger team, while ensuring we supported partners.

WHAT I'M PROUD OF
I learned so many things quickly to upskill myself, including UI design terminology and connecting multiple systems to generate visualizations.

MY GUIDING PRINCIPLE
“We're overwhelmed” is an emotional statement, even if it's rooted in truth. Leaders (and finance) need facts to support feelings, and multiple sets of data give not only reality, but perspective to what's needed.

IF I HAD A DO-OVER
I'd design for automation earlier. As I moved through the process, my skill set evolved so the later work was more polished in process than the original. Designing for limited upkeep would have reduced the amount of work for maintenance.

AT A GLANCE

0 → 1
operating system

3
measurement dimensions

1-person team
at a critical point

OPP
Operations
Productivity
Performance

WHY THIS STORY

I'm comfortable building the infrastructure I wish already existed. When I can't see the work well enough to lead it, my instinct is to create the system, find the signal, and use what I learn to make better decisions.

This story also demonstrates:

Operating model desin

Capacity management

Process design

Hands-on building

Stakeholder influence

- IF WE TALK, ASK ME ABOUT
- Why I let my employee build the first version instead of creating my own.

What the data showed me about capacity that I couldn't prove before.

Why I chose to pause intake instead of asking the team to absorb more work.

How I used the data to show that Design - not effort - was the bottleneck.

How vibe coding changed what I could build without analytics or a development team.